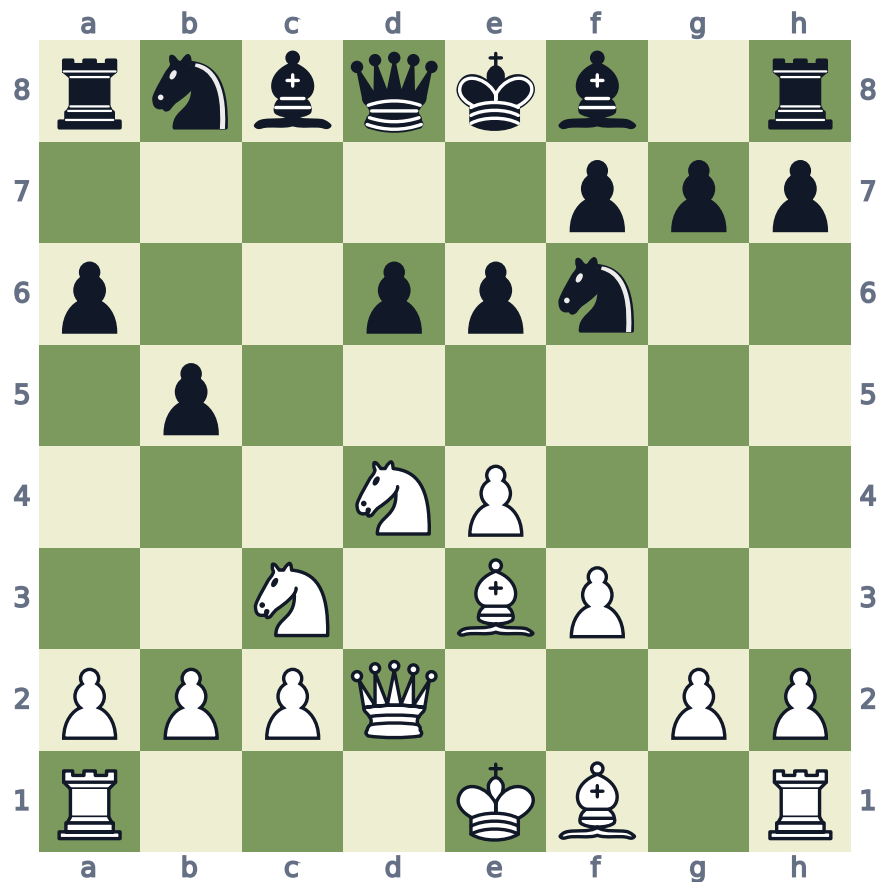


Open Sicilian: Najdorf, Dragon, and Scheveningen

English Attack structures, opposite-side castling, central control, and tactical races



Understand the sharp Open Sicilian families even while the Alapin remains the main practical repertoire.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Understand the sharp Open Sicilian families even while the Alapin remains the main practical repertoire.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

d4 exchanges a flank pawn for Black's central c-pawn.

PRINCIPLE 2

The d4-knight is active but can become a target.

PRINCIPLE 3

Be3, f3, Qd2, and long castling form the English Attack shell.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Opposite-side castling makes tempi and open files critical.

PRINCIPLE 5

Black's ...d5 break is the central equalizing goal.

PRINCIPLE 6

Do not launch pawns before checking counterplay against your king.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

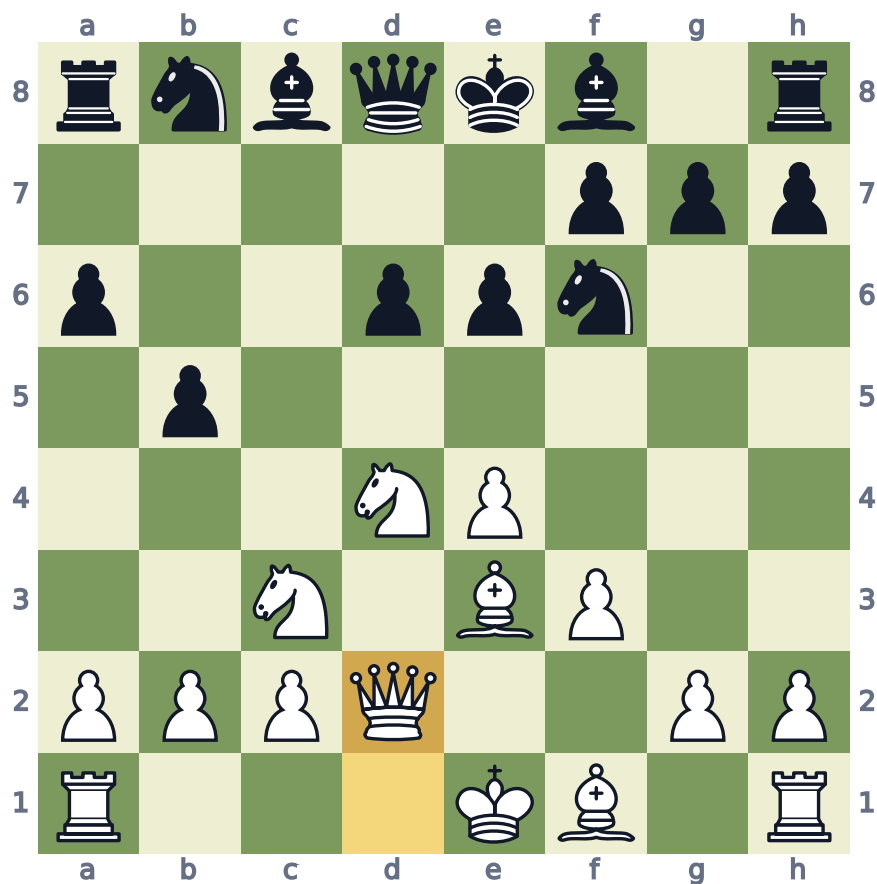
- | | | |
|-----------|--|---|
| 01 | Najdorf English Attack | Be3-f3-Qd2 is a coordinated shell, not three automatic moves. |
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 | | |
| 02 | Najdorf ...e5 | ...e5 trades the d5 weakness for time against the knight. |
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 | | |
| 03 | Najdorf ...Ng4 | When ...Ng4 attacks Be3, compare Bg5, Bc1, and exchanges concretely. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | Najdorf Poisoned Pawn awareness | If Black's queen takes b2, every move must attack the queen or king with purpose. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Dragon Yugoslav setup | In the Dragon, both attacks are real; count tempi before pawn moves. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Dragon with Bc4 | Bc4 is useful when it controls d5 and contributes to development. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Scheveningen shell | The pawns on d6 and e6 create the Scheveningen and make d5 the key square. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Najdorf Be2 alternative | Be2 is a practical alternative that keeps the king flexible. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Najdorf English Attack



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e6 7. f3 b5 8. Qd2

WHITE'S IDEA

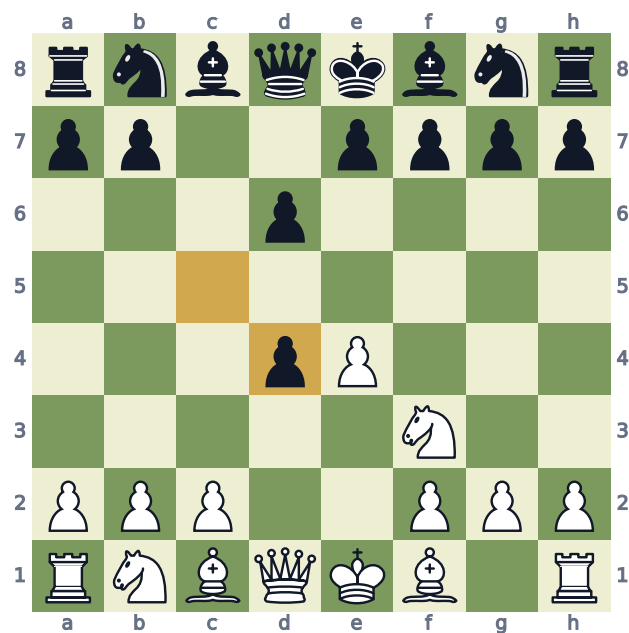
Prepare long castling and a kingside pawn advance while controlling d5.

MAIN DANGER

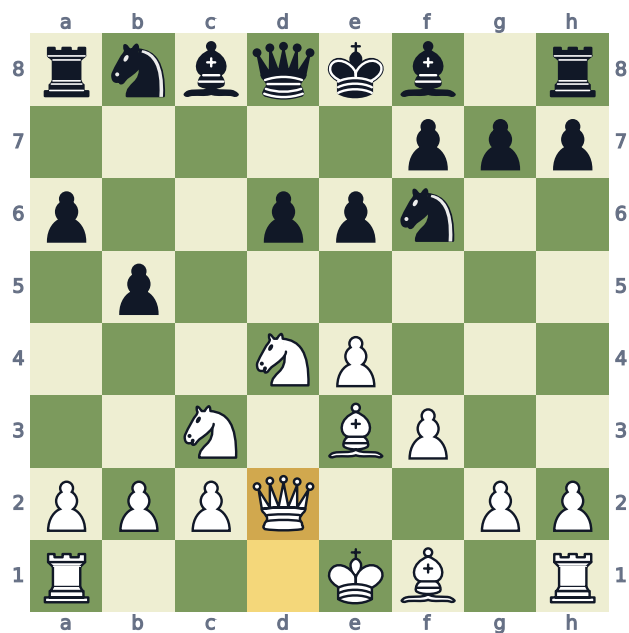
Black's queenside attack can reach first.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Be3-f3-Qd2 is a coordinated shell, not three automatic moves.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

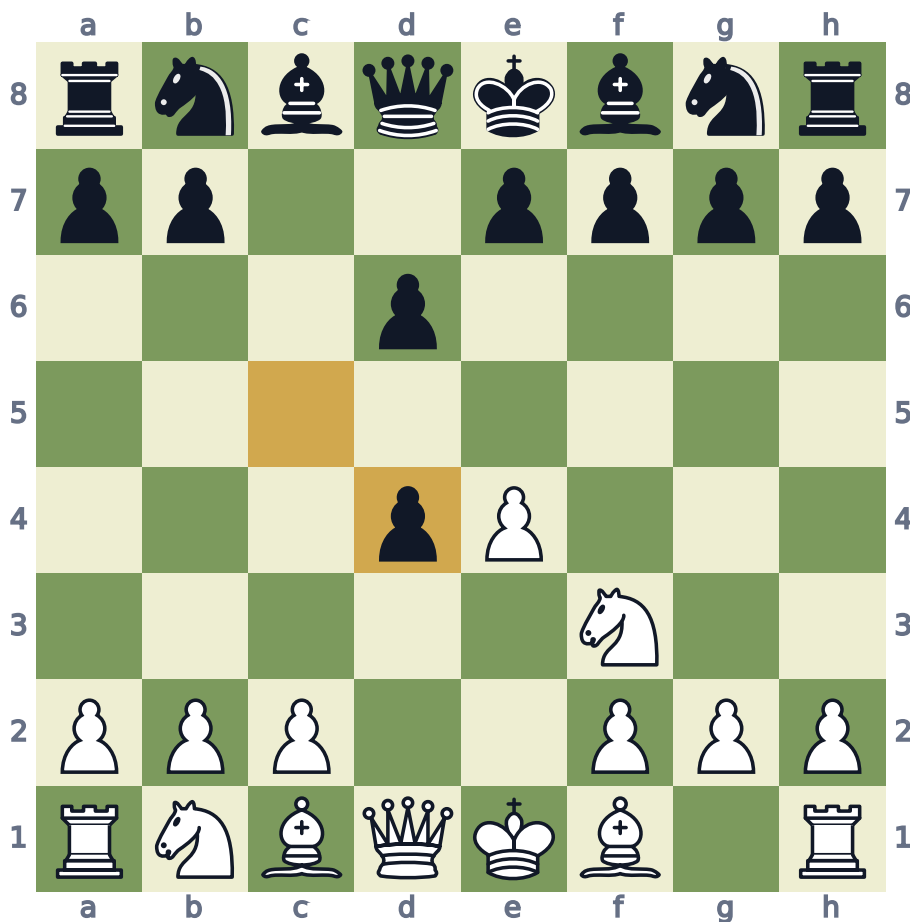
Position estimate: +0.70 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. b4 Na4 2. Qa5 b3 3. d5 e5 4. Nfd7 f4 5. Nc5 Bd3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Najdorf English Attack



YOUR TASK

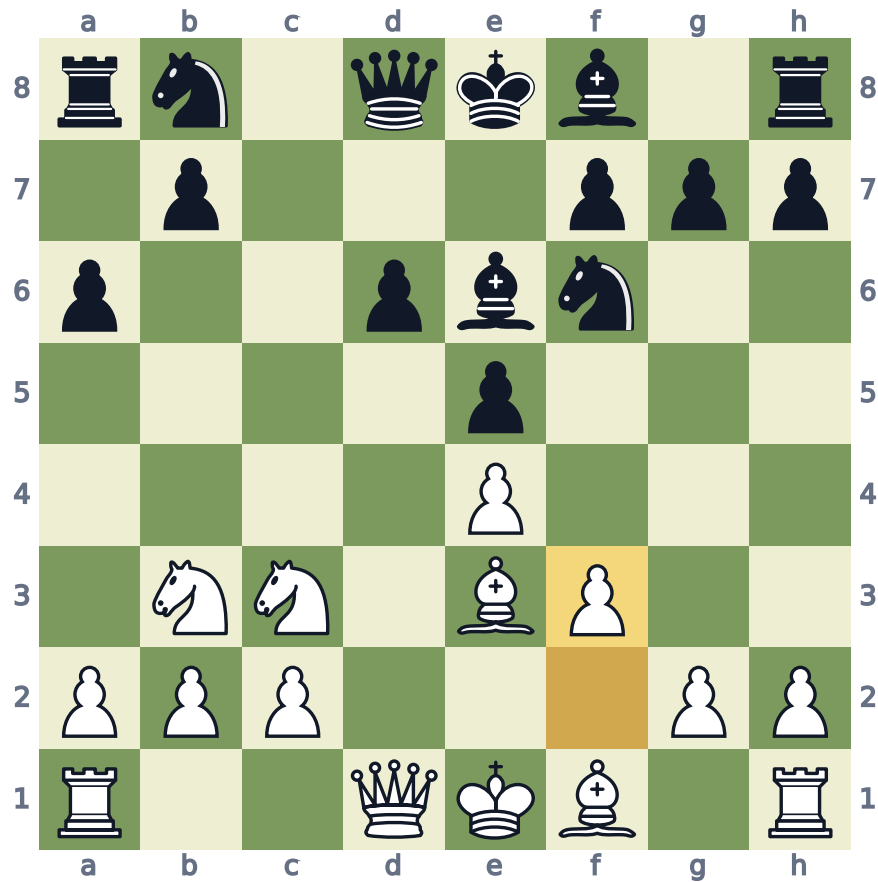
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Najdorf ...e5



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 e5 7. Nb3 Be6 8. f3

WHITE'S IDEA

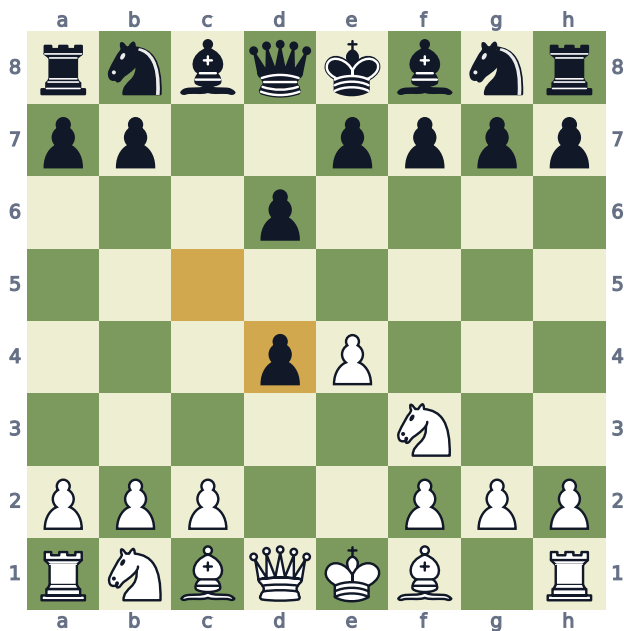
Preserve the knight and use d5 as a long-term outpost.

MAIN DANGER

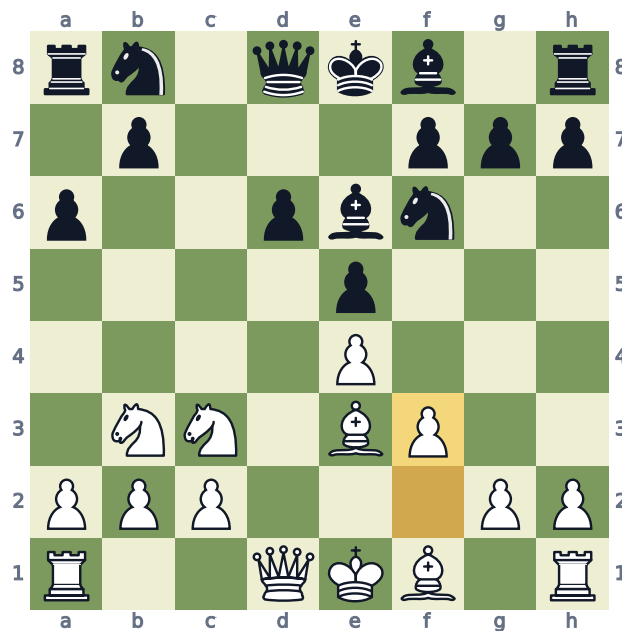
Black gains space and can attack d5 with pieces.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...e5 trades the d5 weakness for time against the knight.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

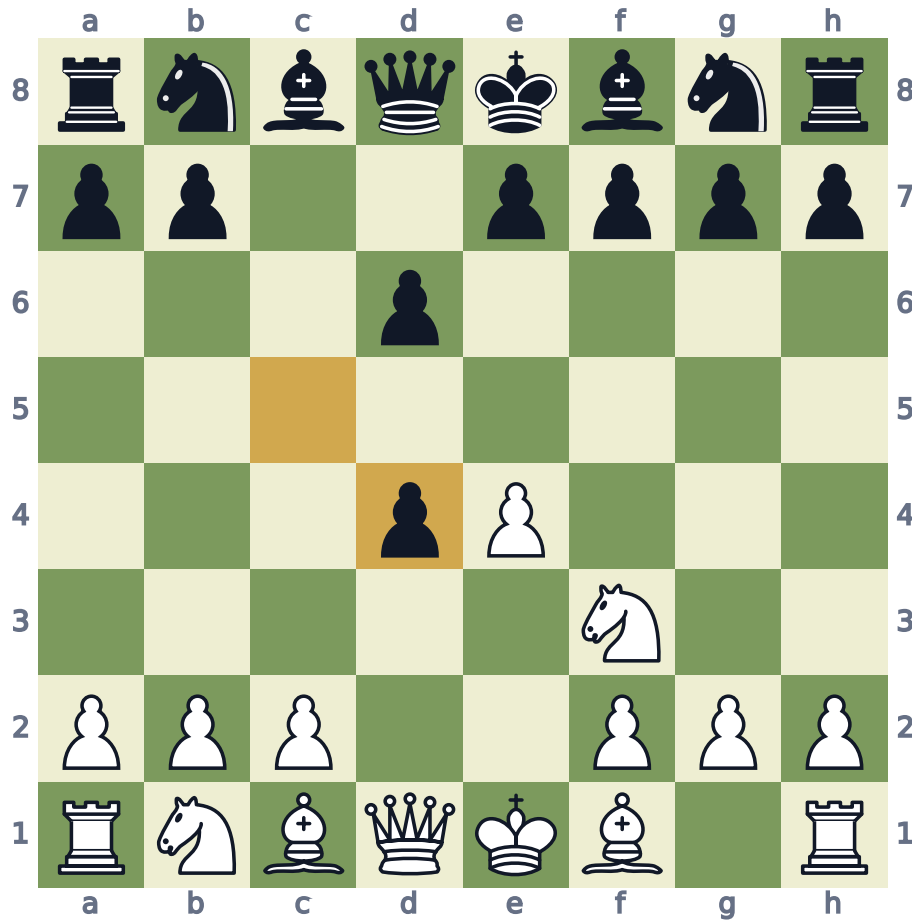
Position estimate: +0.27 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be7 Qd2 2. h5 Nd5 3. Bxd5 exd5 4. Nbd7 c4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Najdorf ...e5



YOUR TASK

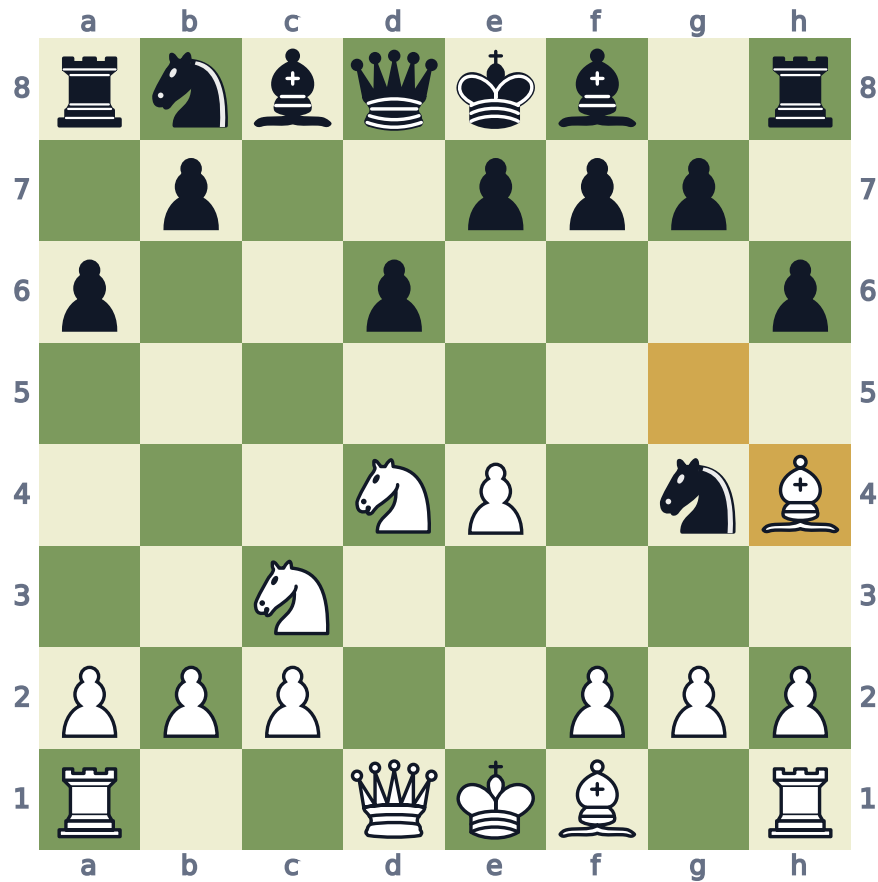
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Najdorf ...Ng4



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be3 Ng4 7. Bg5 h6 8. Bh4

WHITE'S IDEA

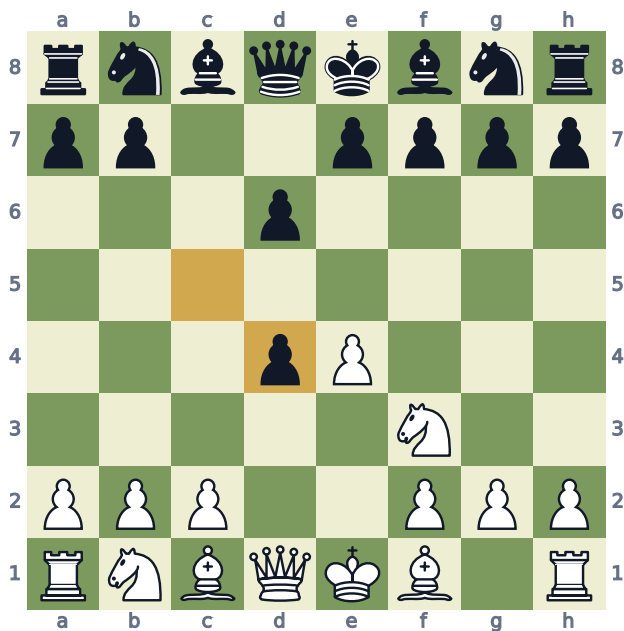
Keep useful pressure while avoiding an unfavorable bishop trade.

MAIN DANGER

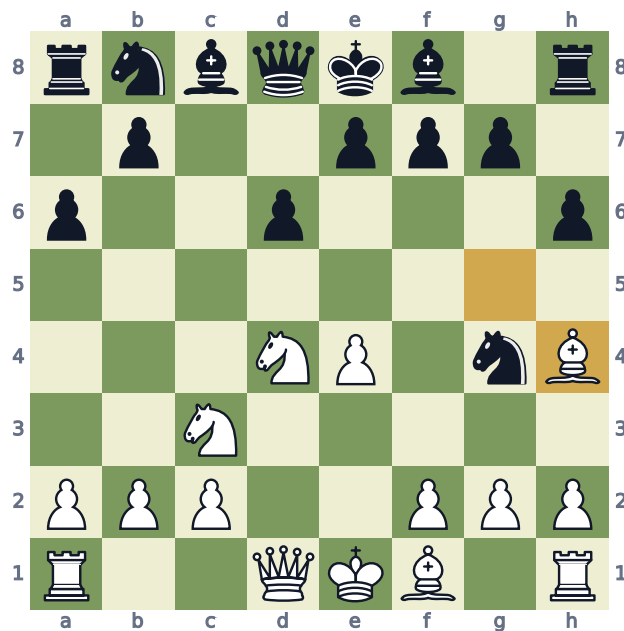
The bishop can lose tempi and become trapped.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When ...Ng4 attacks Be3, compare Bg5, Bc1, and exchanges concretely.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

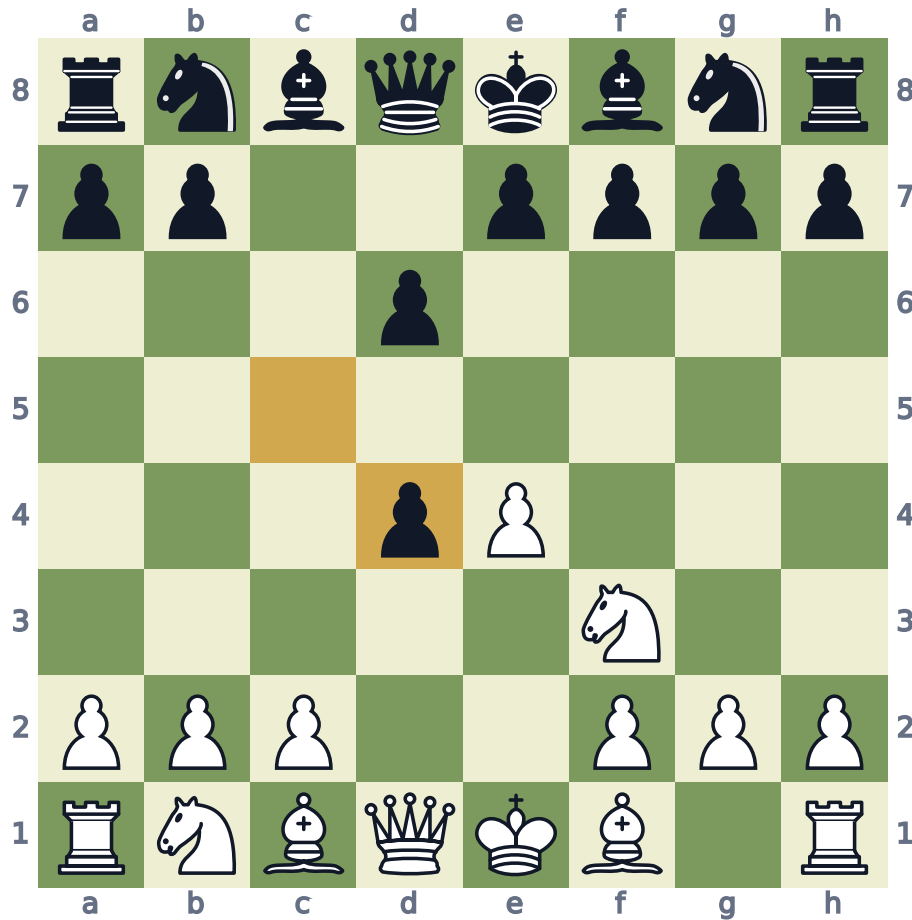
Position estimate: +0.49 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. g5 Bg3 2. Bg7 Qd2 3. Nc6 Nb3 4. Be6 O-O-O 5. Nge5 h4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Najdorf ...Ng4



YOUR TASK

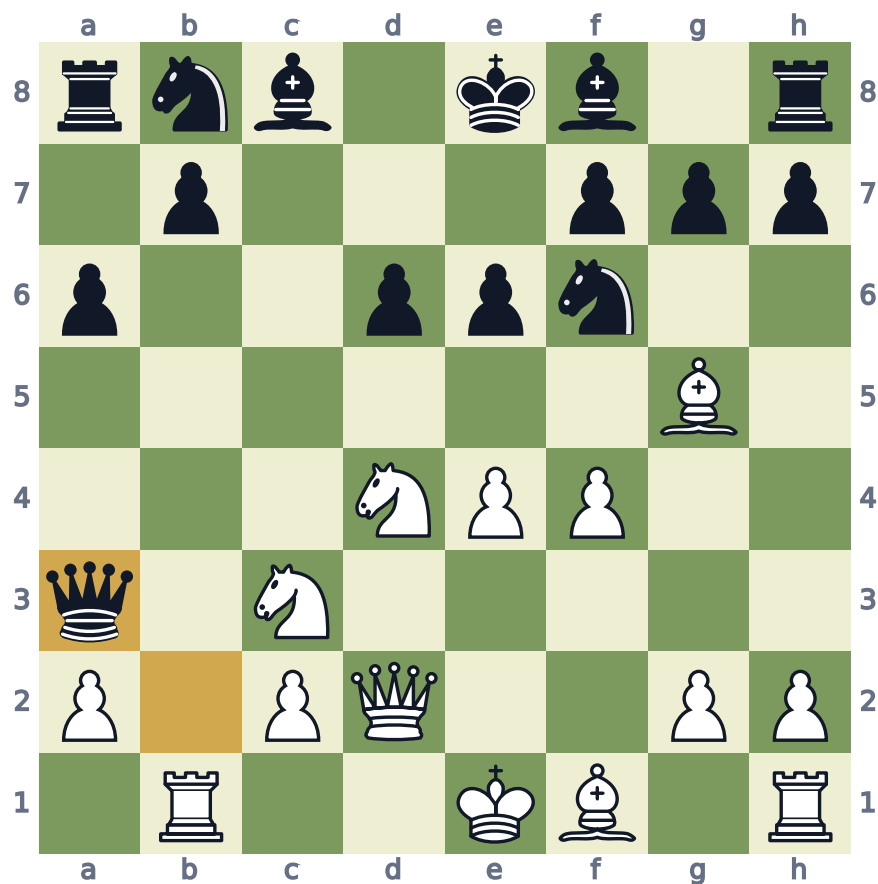
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Najdorf Poisoned Pawn awareness



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Bg5 e6 7. f4 Qb6 8. Qd2 Qxb2 9. Rb1 Qa3

WHITE'S IDEA

Use development and open lines as compensation for b2.

MAIN DANGER

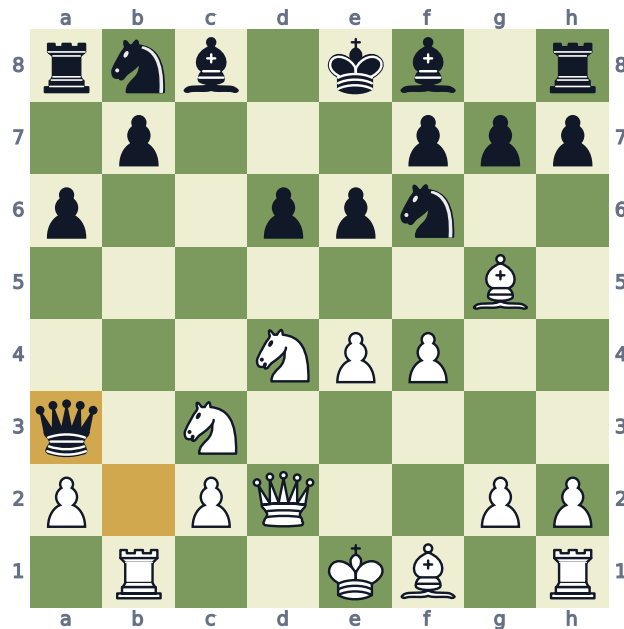
This line is highly tactical and requires exact calculation.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

If Black's queen takes b2, every move must attack the queen or king with purpose.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.20 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be2 Be7 2. O-O Qa5 3. Kh1 Nc6 4. Rf3 O-O 5. Rg3 Nxd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Najdorf Poisoned Pawn awareness



YOUR TASK

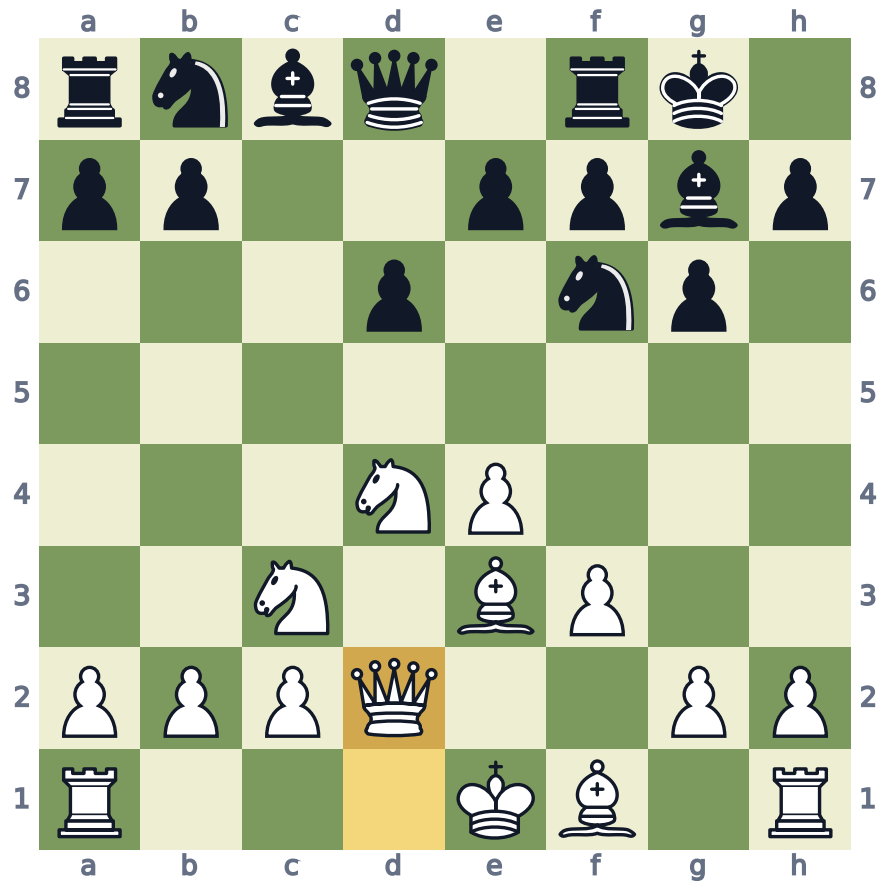
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Dragon Yugoslav setup



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2

WHITE'S IDEA

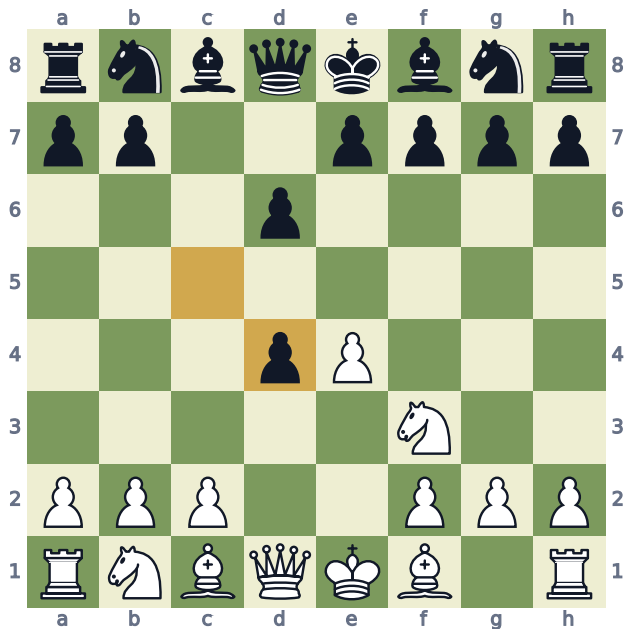
Prepare long castling and h4-h5 while controlling d5.

MAIN DANGER

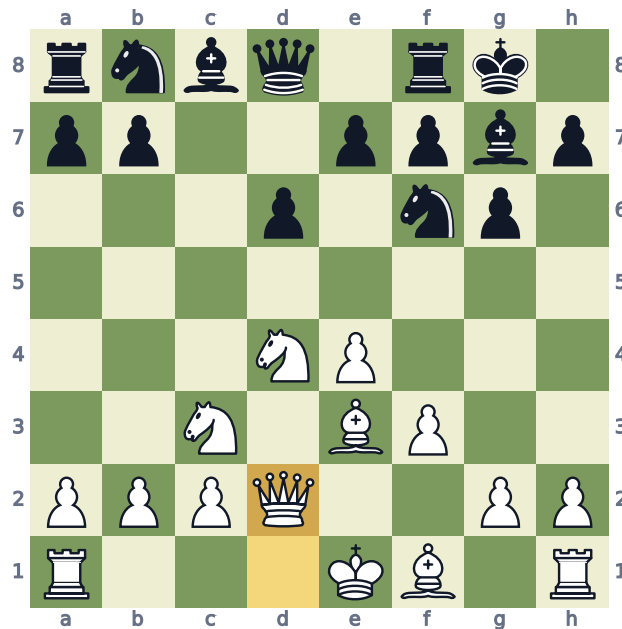
The c-file and g7 bishop target White's queenside king.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

In the Dragon, both attacks are real; count tempi before pawn moves.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

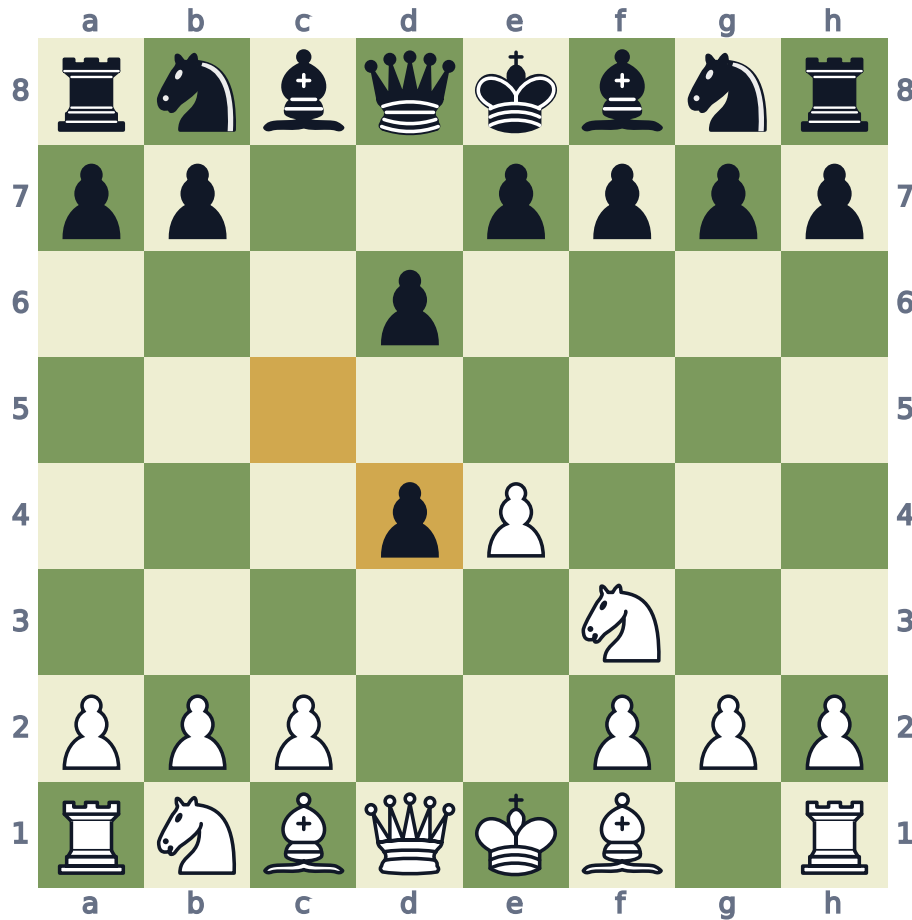
Position estimate: +0.73 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 g4 2. Nxd4 Bxd4 3. Be6 h4 4. h5 O-O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Dragon Yugoslav setup



YOUR TASK

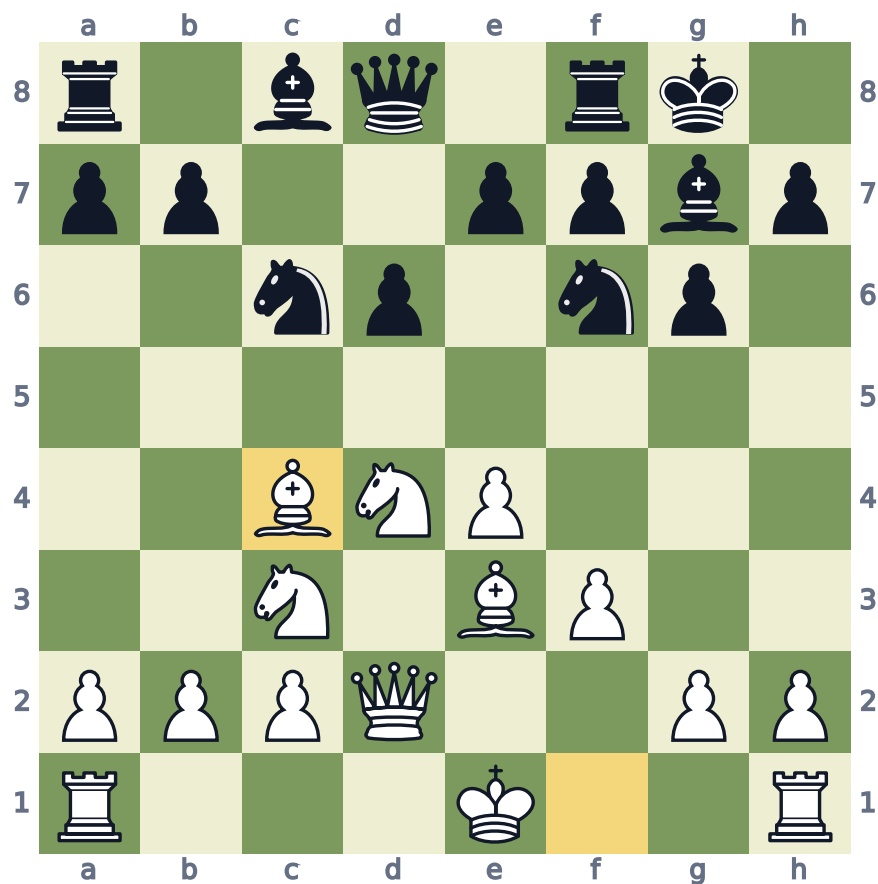
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Dragon with Bc4



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 g6 6. Be3 Bg7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2 Nc6 9. Bc4

WHITE'S IDEA

Develop with tempo against d5 and support the attacking setup.

MAIN DANGER

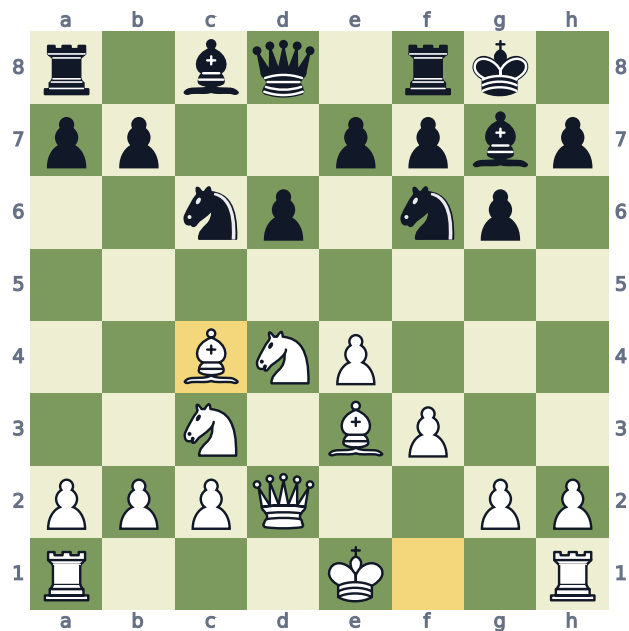
Bc4 can be hit by ...Ne5 or ...Na5.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Bc4 is useful when it controls d5 and contributes to development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.52 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nxd4 Bxd4 2. Be6 Bb3 3. Bxb3 axb3 4. a5 O-O-O

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Dragon with Bc4



YOUR TASK

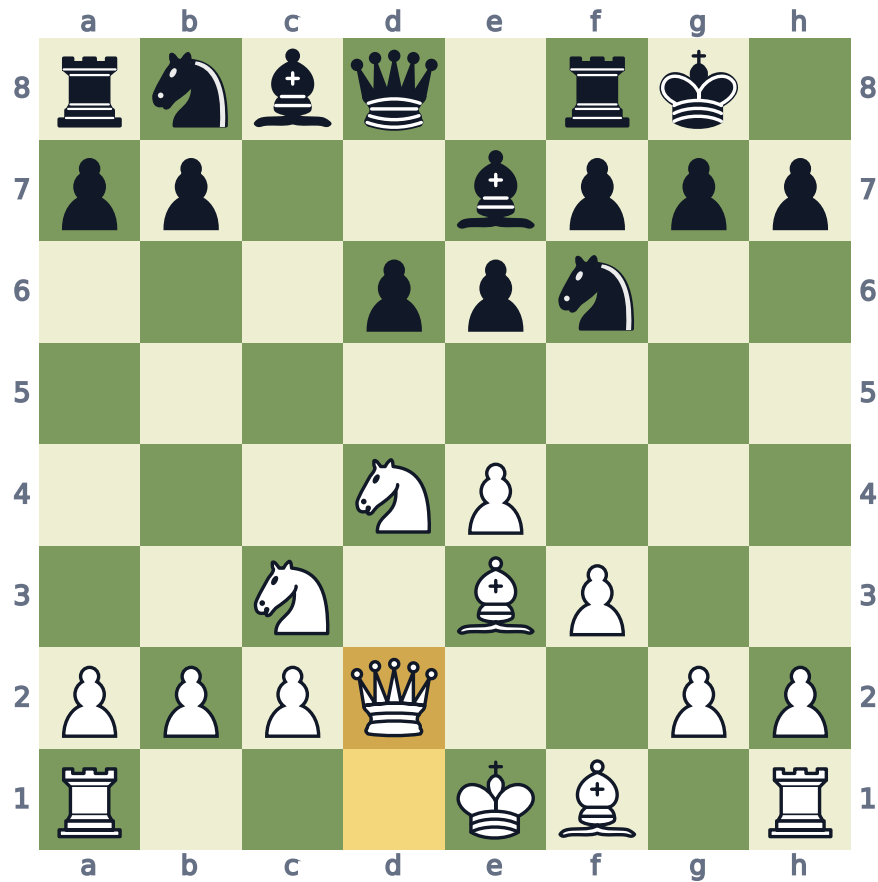
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Scheveningen shell



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 e6 6. Be3 Be7 7. f3 O-O 8. Qd2

WHITE'S IDEA

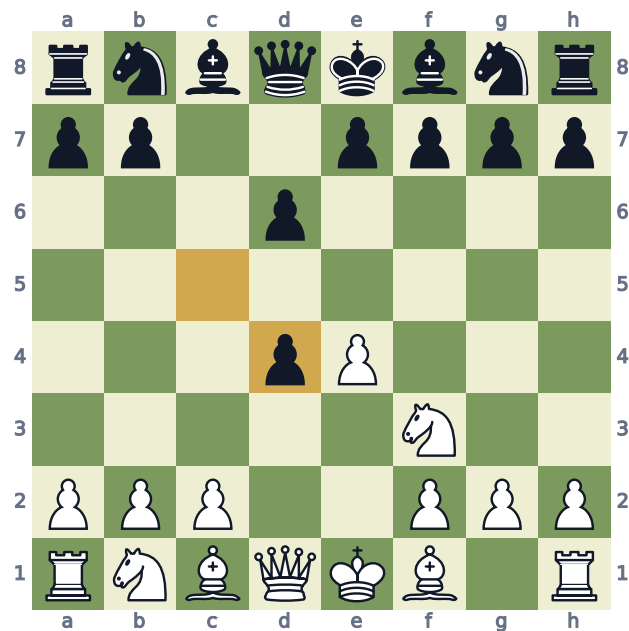
Use space and prepare long castling against Black's compact center.

MAIN DANGER

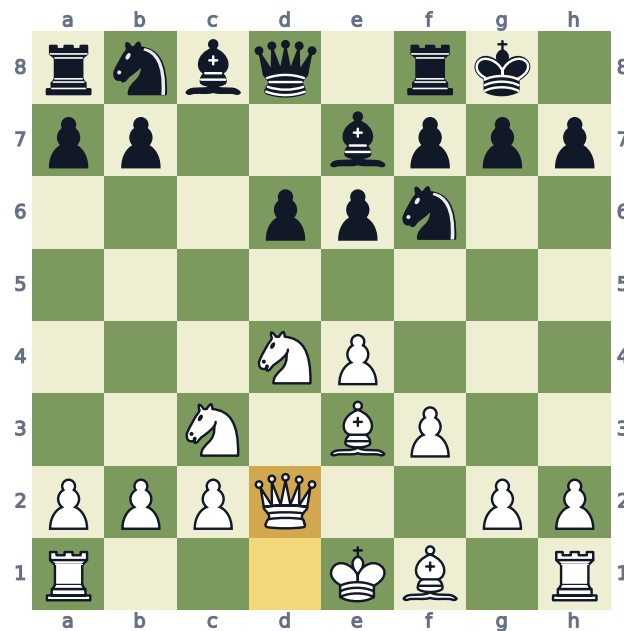
Black's ...d5 break can equalize immediately if allowed.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The pawns on d6 and e6 create the Scheveningen and make d5 the key square.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

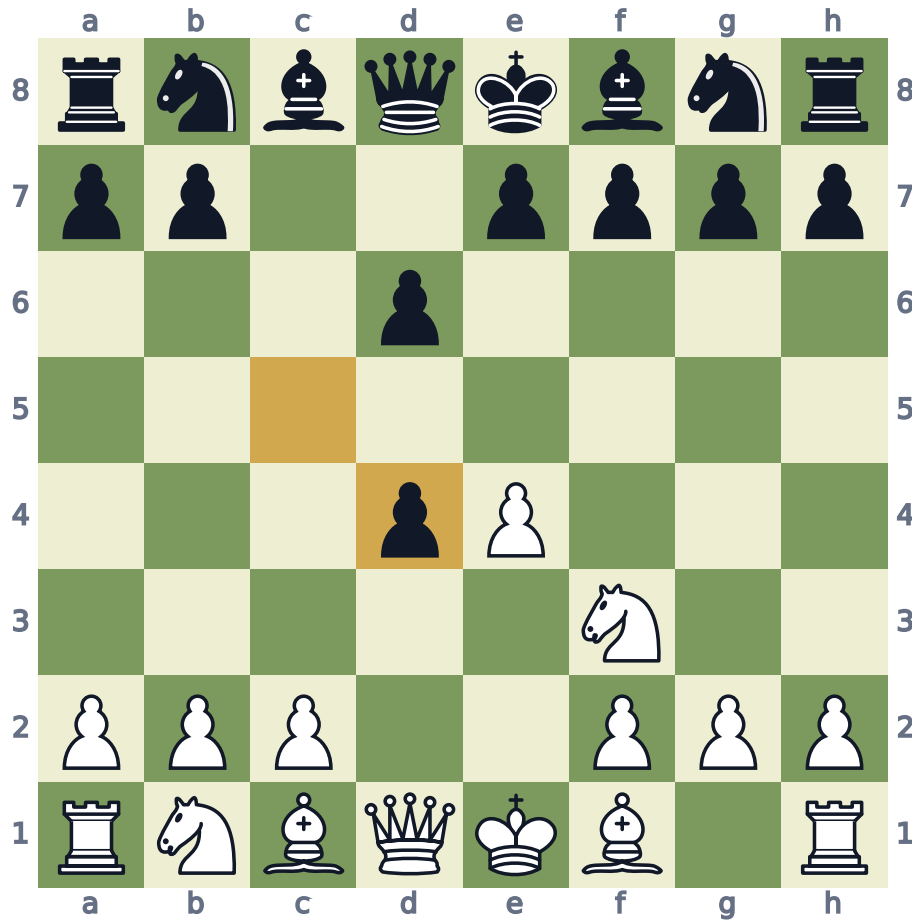
Position estimate: +0.53 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 O-O-O 2. d5 exd5 3. Nxd5 Nxd5 4. Qxd5 Kb1 5. Nxd4 Qxd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Scheveningen shell



YOUR TASK

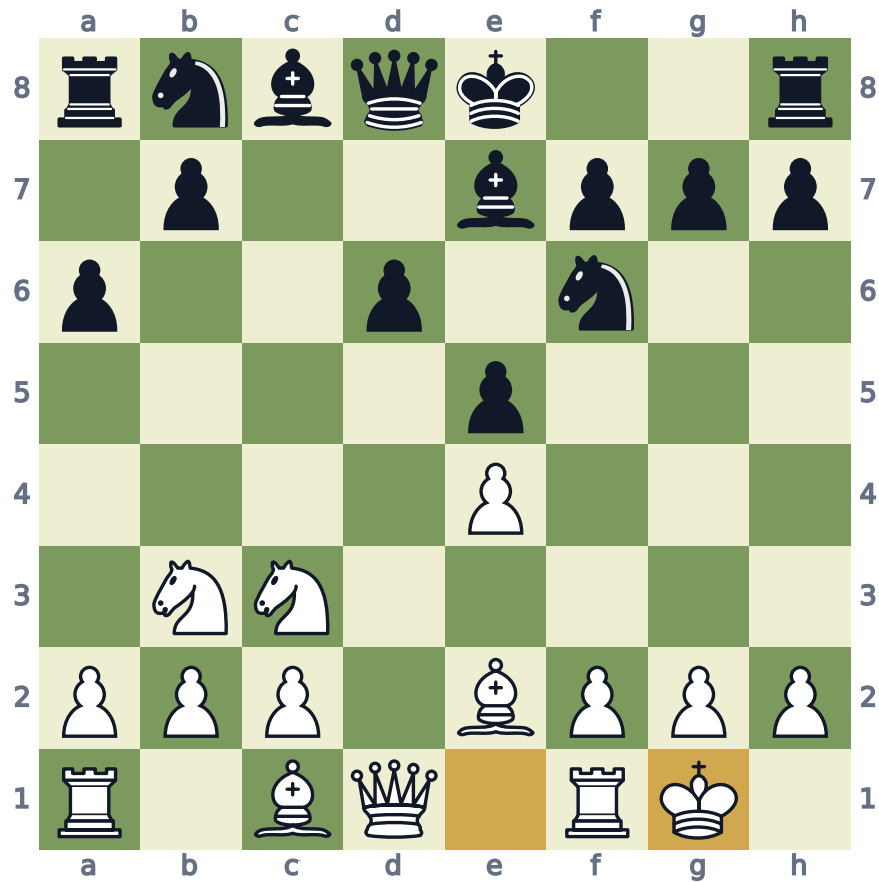
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Najdorf Be2 alternative



COURSE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 d6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nf6 5. Nc3 a6 6. Be2 e5 7. Nb3 Be7 8. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

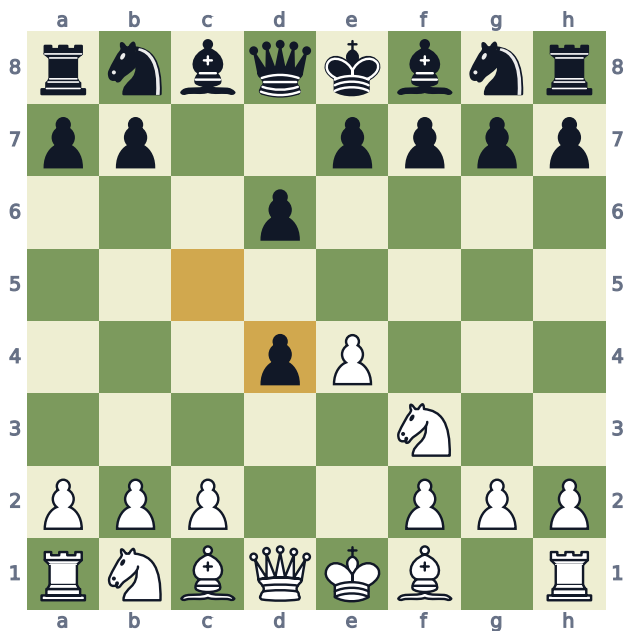
Choose short castling and positional control when a tactical race is unwanted.

MAIN DANGER

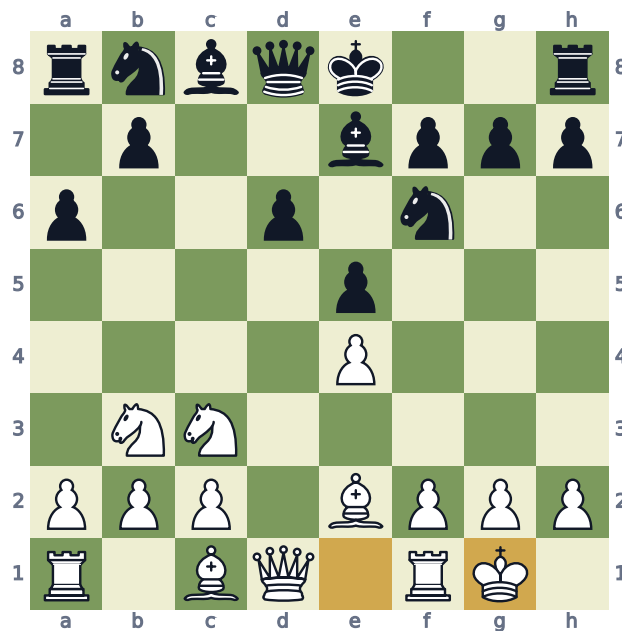
A quiet setup still must meet ...Be6 and ...d5.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Be2 is a practical alternative that keeps the king flexible.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

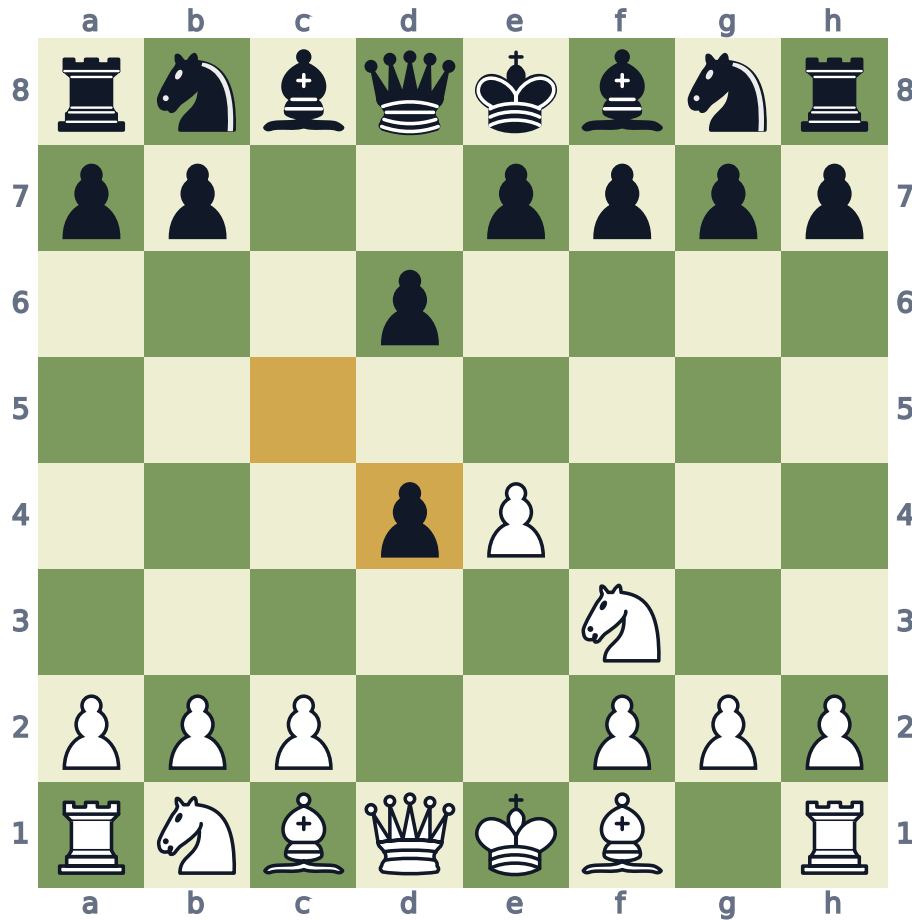
Position estimate: +0.29 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O Be3 2. Be6 a4 3. Nc6 a5 4. Rc8 Ra4 5. d5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Najdorf Be2 alternative



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. NAJDORF ENGLISH ATTACK

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Prepare long castling and a kingside pawn advance while controlling d5. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 a6 3. Be3 e5 4. Nb3 Be7 5. f3 Nc6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black's queenside attack can reach first.

02. NAJDORF ...E5

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Preserve the knight and use d5 as a long-term outpost. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 a6 3. Be3 e5 4. Nb3 Be7 5. f3 Nc6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black gains space and can attack d5 with pieces.

03. NAJDORF ...NG4

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Keep useful pressure while avoiding an unfavorable bishop trade. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 a6 3. Be3 e5 4. Nb3 Be7 5. f3 Nc6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The bishop can lose tempi and become trapped.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. NAJDORF POISONED PAWN AWARENESS

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use development and open lines as compensation for b2. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 a6 2. Be2 e5 3. Nb3 Be7 4. g4 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: This line is highly tactical and requires exact calculation.

05. DRAGON YUGOSLAV SETUP

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Prepare long castling and h4-h5 while controlling d5. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 a6 3. Be3 e5 4. Nb3 Be7 5. f3 Nc6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The c-file and g7 bishop target White's queenside king.

06. DRAGON WITH BC4

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Develop with tempo against d5 and support the attacking setup. Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 a6 2. Be2 e5 3. Nb3 Be7 4. g4 (+0.33 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Bc4 can be hit by ...Ne5 or ...Na5.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. SCHEVENINGEN SHELL

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Use space and prepare long castling against Black's compact center. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 a6 3. Be3 e5 4. Nb3 Be7 5. f3 Nc6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black's ...d5 break can equalize immediately if allowed.

08. NAJDORF BE2 ALTERNATIVE

Course move: Nxd4. Purpose: Choose short castling and positional control when a tactical race is unwanted. Engine comparison: 1. Nxd4 Nf6 2. Nc3 a6 3. Be3 e5 4. Nb3 Be7 5. f3 Nc6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A quiet setup still must meet ...Be6 and ...d5.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.